

Proposed child arrangements plan

Harrison has suggested a child arrangements plan

Harrison used the [Child Arrangements Plan service](https://propose-child-arrangements-plan.service.gov.uk/) (<https://propose-child-arrangements-plan.service.gov.uk/>) on GOV.UK to suggest a plan for how you both might look after Jason.

How to respond to this plan

You do not have to respond to this plan if you do not want to.

Any plan you make using this form is not legally binding. The other person does not have to do what it says and either of you can suggest changes to it at any time.

If you decide not to respond to this plan, you can still:

- start your own child arrangements plan on GOV.UK
- make your own written agreement without using a template or service

Your safety

You should only respond to the suggested plan if:

- you're confident that you and your ex-partner can make decisions together without putting yourself or the children in danger
- you do not feel pressured or intimidated into responding

If you have any concerns about safety, stop now.

If you have any feedback or safety concerns about this service, you can email childarrangementssafety@justice.gov.uk.

We cannot answer any questions about child arrangement plans that have already been created.

How to use this plan together

You can use this document to agree on child arrangements together.

For each section of the plan, you can choose whether you agree or disagree, and add your own comments. You can then send the reviewed document directly back to Harrison.

How making a child arrangements plan can help

You may find that collaborating with Harrison on a child arrangements plan:

- is cheaper and quicker than going to court (it usually takes around 10 months to get a court order, depending on where you live and whether it's urgent)
- leads to a better outcome for your children, which you and your ex-partner are in control of

Going to court can sometimes mean you are not the ones who make the final decisions about your child arrangements.

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Tips to help you and your children

Your child arrangements plan should:

- put the child's welfare first
- reflect the wishes, feelings and needs of the child
- consider any harm the child has suffered or any risk of harm

If there is a court order in place

Do not continue if there's a court order in place relating to you, the other parent, or the children.

For example, a:

- child arrangements order
- specific issue order
- prohibited steps order
- protective order such as a non-molestation order, occupation order or a domestic abuse protection order
- any other order restricting contact between you and the other parent or the children

To change or enforce an existing child arrangements order, visit <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce/change-or-enforce-an-order>.

Get more information

Use GOV.UK to find more information, for example:

- making child arrangements - <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce>
- getting a legal separation - <https://www.gov.uk/legal-separation>
- getting a divorce - <https://www.gov.uk/get-a-divorce>

If you want legal advice

You can find a legal adviser: <https://www.gov.uk/find-legal-advice/find-legal-adviser>.

Getting help with domestic abuse

To find out more about signs and effects of child abuse and neglect, visit <https://www.nspcc.org.uk/what-is-child-abuse>.

If you're unsure whether you're a victim of domestic abuse, visit <https://www.gov.uk/guidance/domestic-abuse-how-to-get-help#recognise-domestic-abuse>.

This plan is not suitable for you if there has been:

- any form of domestic abuse or violence, even if the abuse was not directed at the children
- actual or attempted child abduction
- child abuse or neglect
- misuse of drugs, alcohol or other substances
- any other safety or welfare concerns that place anyone at significant risk of harm

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Feedback and support

To ask for help using this service, or suggest improvements, you can email childarrangements@justice.gov.uk.

We cannot answer any questions about child arrangement plans that have already been created.

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About this child arrangements proposal

Harrison said:

- there is no court order in place at this time
- this is a proposed child arrangements plan for 1 child, Jason
- this agreement is between Harrison and Jennifer, who are the adults who will care for Jason

Do you and Harrison agree about the children's names, your names, and whether there is a court order in place?

Yes ☐ No ☐

We do not store these names or share any of this information with other government departments.

If you answered 'No', it may be helpful to find a mediator who can help you agree your child arrangements. You can get financial help with this. To find out more, go to <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce>.

Living and visiting

Where will the children spend most of their time?

Harrison suggested that the children spend most of their time with Jennifer.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest where the children will spend most of their time

Will the children stay overnight with Harrison?

Harrison suggested that the children stay overnight at Harrison's home.

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Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest whether the children will stay overnight with Harrison

On which days will overnights happen?

Harrison suggested that overnight visits happen on Tuesday and Thursday.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest when the children will stay overnight with Harrison

Will the children do daytime visits with Harrison?

Harrison suggested that the children do daytime visits to Harrison's home.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest whether the children will do daytime visits

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On which days will daytime visits happen?

Harrison suggested that daytime visits happen on Monday and Saturday.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest when the children will do daytime visits

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the living and visiting section

Handovers and holidays

How will the children get between households?

Harrison suggested that Harrison collects the children.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest how the children get between households

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Where does handover take place?

It may be easier for children if the handover takes place at a neutral location which you're confident you'll both feel safe in.

Harrison suggested that handover takes place at Jennifer's home and school

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest where handover takes place

Will these arrangements change during school holidays?

Harrison suggested that these arrangements should change during school holidays.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest whether the arrangements should change during the holidays

How will the arrangements be different in school holidays?

School holidays include half terms, bank holidays and inset days.

Harrison suggested:

"Trip to Malaga"

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Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest how the arrangements should change during the holidays

What items need to go between households?

Harrison suggested:
"Toothbrush, PS5, Laptop and Teddy Bear"

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest which items need to go between households

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the handovers and holidays section

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Special days

What will happen on special days?

Keep your children’s needs and best interests at the centre of your plans for holidays and meaningful events. For example, New Year celebrations, Mother’s Day and Father’s Day, and birthdays.

Harrison suggested that this does not need to be decided.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐

No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest what will happen on special days

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the special days section

Other things

What other things matter to your children?

You may want to agree things such as:

- religious practices, diet, and standard rules across both households
- extra-curricular activities, such as swimming lessons
- access to other friends and family
- other types of contact, such as video calls

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Harrison suggested:

"video calls"

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest what other things matter to your children

End of section

You can use this space to write your agreed answer for the other things section

Decision making

How should last-minute changes be communicated?

There will be times when plans will need to change, such as if one parent is suddenly unwell and cannot collect a child from school.

Harrison suggested that last-minute changes should be communicated by text message and with a phone call.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

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If you do not agree, suggest how last minute changes should be communicated

How much notice should you give to change long-term arrangements?

Sometimes you may need to plan a long way ahead. For example, if you want to plan a holiday during time you do not usually spend with the children.

Harrison suggested that you should both give each other 8 weeks' notice to change long-term arrangements.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest how much notice you should give each other

When would you like to review this plan?

Children's needs change as they grow. When should you review this agreement to check it is still what's best for the children?

Harrison suggested that you should review this arrangement in 6 months' time.

Do you agree?

Yes ☐ No ☐

If you do not agree, suggest when should you review this agreement

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What to do next

You can send this proposed child arrangements plan back to Harrison. You should try to create a written record of what you have both agreed.

Any plan you make using this form is not legally binding. The other person does not have to do what it says and either of you can suggest changes to it at any time.

If there is no response

If you are unable to make an agreement between yourselves, you could try mediation or another way of agreeing outside of court.

A mediator is a professional who will work with you to help you make decisions based on your child's best interests. They listen to both of you and take a neutral approach.

More information and support is available at: <https://www.gov.uk/looking-after-children-divorce>.

Get paid to give your feedback

With your help we can improve this service and understand how you use your plan.

Sign up and receive an incentive when you take part in further research

<https://www.smartsurvey.co.uk/s/EFO5FJ/>